

Propylene Glycol Market Size, Share and Forecast 2036

The propylene glycol market was valued at USD 4.7 billion in 2026 and is projected to reach USD 8.74 billion by the end of 2036, registering a CAGR of around 6.4% during 2027-2036. Market expansion is being supported by the broad application of propylene glycol as a solvent, humectant, carrier, heat-transfer fluid, and chemical intermediate. Increasing demand from food processing, pharmaceuticals, personal care, construction, and transportation is expected to create sustained opportunities for manufacturers.

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Propylene Glycol Industry Demand

[Propylene glycol](#) is a clear, nearly odorless, hygroscopic liquid that is widely used across industrial and consumer applications. Its ability to dissolve numerous substances, retain moisture, provide freeze protection, and maintain formulation stability makes it an important ingredient and processing material.

Demand is increasing because propylene glycol can provide cost-effective formulation and processing performance, while its compatibility with different ingredients makes it convenient to incorporate into diverse products. In food and pharmaceutical applications, appropriate grades can support product stability and extended shelf life. It is also used in cosmetics as a humectant and solvent, in building applications for heat-transfer systems, and in transportation-related fluids such as coolants and antifreeze formulations. Growing interest in bio-based chemicals is additionally encouraging manufacturers to develop alternative production pathways.

Propylene Glycol Market: Growth Drivers & Key Restraint

Growth Drivers –

- **Expanding Pharmaceutical and Personal Care Applications:** Propylene glycol is widely used as a solvent, carrier, humectant, and formulation aid in pharmaceutical products, cosmetics, skincare products, and other personal care formulations. Increasing consumption of these products is supporting demand for suitable-quality propylene glycol.
- **Rising Demand for Food and Beverage Processing:** Propylene glycol serves as a solvent, moisture-retention agent, and formulation ingredient in various food applications. Its functional properties and compatibility with numerous ingredients support its use in processed food and beverage manufacturing.
- **Increasing Industrial and Automotive Applications:** The material is used in coolants, antifreeze systems, heat-transfer fluids, resins, coatings, and other industrial products.

Expansion of construction, manufacturing, transportation, and chemical-processing activities is therefore creating additional consumption opportunities.

Restraint –

- Fluctuations in feedstock and energy costs can affect production economics and product prices. Environmental considerations surrounding petroleum-derived chemicals and competition from alternative solvents, glycols, and bio-based materials can also influence market development.

Propylene Glycol Market: Segment Analysis

Segment Analysis by Source – Petroleum-Based and Bio-Based:

Petroleum-based propylene glycol remains widely utilized because of established manufacturing infrastructure, consistent availability, and its suitability for large-scale industrial applications. Demand is supported by transportation fluids, construction materials, chemical processing, and other high-volume uses. Bio-based propylene glycol is gaining attention as manufacturers and end users seek lower-impact feedstocks and more sustainable chemical production. Its adoption is particularly relevant to companies pursuing renewable sourcing and sustainability targets.

Segment Analysis by End User:

Transportation uses propylene glycol in antifreeze, coolants, de-icing formulations, and other fluid systems. Building & Construction applications include heat-transfer fluids, unsaturated polyester resins, coatings, and related materials. The Food & Beverage sector uses suitable-grade propylene glycol as a solvent, humectant, and carrier. Pharmaceuticals represent an important application because of its role in formulations and drug-delivery products. Cosmetics & Personal Care manufacturers utilize it for moisture retention, ingredient dispersion, and formulation stability. Demand across these industries is influenced by product manufacturing volumes, formulation requirements, and regulatory standards.

Segment Analysis by Grade – Industrial Grade and USP Grade:

Industrial-grade propylene glycol serves applications where technical performance, solvent characteristics, thermal properties, and cost efficiency are the primary considerations. It is used in coatings, resins, coolants, heat-transfer fluids, and industrial chemical processes. USP-grade propylene glycol is manufactured to meet stringent quality requirements and is important for pharmaceutical, food, personal care, and other applications where controlled purity is essential.

Propylene Glycol Market: Regional Insights

North America

The regional market is supported by established chemical manufacturing, pharmaceutical production, food processing, and automotive industries. Demand is also influenced by the use

of propylene glycol in coolants, heat-transfer systems, personal care formulations, and pharmaceutical products. Development of bio-based alternatives is contributing to product innovation.

Europe

Europe has significant demand from pharmaceutical, cosmetics, food processing, automotive, and specialty chemical industries. Sustainability objectives and efforts to reduce dependence on fossil-based raw materials are encouraging interest in bio-based propylene glycol and more resource-efficient manufacturing processes.

Asia-Pacific (APAC)

APAC is supported by expanding manufacturing capacity, urbanization, industrial development, and rising consumption of pharmaceuticals, packaged foods, cosmetics, and personal care products. Growing automotive and construction activities are creating additional applications for propylene glycol, while investments in chemical production are strengthening regional supply capabilities.

Top Players in the Propylene Glycol Market

The propylene glycol market includes Dow, BASF SE, Temix Oleo, INEOS Oxide, Huntsman International, Haike Chemical Group Co., Ltd., Repsol, Shell Plc, ADEKA Corporation, LyondellBasell Industries N.V., and Metadynea LLC. These companies participate in the market through production expansion, product-grade development, feedstock diversification, technological improvements, sustainability initiatives, strategic partnerships, and efforts to serve specialized requirements across pharmaceutical, food, personal care, automotive, construction, and industrial applications.

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